Unit 1 · Present simple and present continuous

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

Present simple tells what we do again and again. Present continuous tells what is happening right now.

Present simple — привычка, что мы делаем обычно. Present continuous — что происходит прямо сейчас.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Habit	subject · verb (he / she / it) · -s)	**She usually has pasta.**	Она обычно ест пасту.
Now	am / is / are · verb-ing	**She's having pizza now.**	Сейчас она ест пиццу.
Habit words	always · usually · sometimes · rarely · never	**I never drink coffee.**	Я никогда не пью кофе.
Now words	now · today · right now · at the moment	**Look! They're eating.**	Смотри! Они едят.
Position	BEFORE a verb, AFTER am / is / are	**He is usually happy. He usually has lunch.**	

When we use it

Say what we do every day: We usually have lunch at school.
Сказать, что мы делаем обычно.

Say what is happening now: I'm drinking milk right now.
Сказать, что происходит сейчас.

Order food: Can I have a bowl of soup, please?
Заказать еду.

REMEMBER

usually / every day → present simple. now / today / right now / at the moment → present continuous (am / is / are + -ing).

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

In Russian the same verb is used for both: «Я ем суп» (always or now). In English we must choose: I eat soup (always) or I'm eating soup (now).

Watch out! We often say...

~~I eating soup now.~~	**I'm eating soup now.**
~~She is drink milk.~~	**She is drinking milk.**
~~He is usually have lunch at school.~~	**He usually has lunch at school.**
~~They usually are late.~~	**They are usually late.**

EASY TRICK

Ask yourself: is it a habit (every day) or is it happening NOW? Habit → plain verb. Now → am / is / are + -ing.

Try it! Circle the right answer

1. We usually ___ pasta. (have / are having)
2. Look! They ___ pizza. (have / are having)
3. She ___ milk every day. (drinks / is drinking)
4. I ___ my homework right now. (do / am doing)
5. He ___ eats soup. (never / is never)
6. It ___ today. (rains / is raining)

Answers: 1 have · 2 are having · 3 drinks · 4 am doing · 5 never · 6 is raining